

NEWS RELEASE

TANDY CORPORATION/RADIO SHACK

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SUBJECT: TRS-80® ARCNET

TRS-80® ARCNET Networking System for TRS-80 Model II and Model 12 microcomputers.

The TRS-80® ARCNET, Networking System from Radio Shack, a division of Tandy Corporation, is a local area network based on Datapoint's field-proven "Attached Resource Computer Network".

ARCNET protocols and software plus an LSI integrated circuit network interface component allows multiple TRS-80 Model II or Model 12 microcomputers to be linked into effectively large scale systems to create a low cost local networking system for up to 255 microcomputers. These microcomputers can access common hard disk files and share the use of peripherals throughout the network. ARCNET is compatible with most Radio Shack Model II software (currently over fifty programs) including packages for accounting, word processing, electronic filing systems, inventory control and more.

Hardware requirements for ARCNET consist of only three components - a printed circuit board, coaxial cable and a junction hub. Each computer requires an ARCNET Interface Card (26-6501) available for \$399.00 (required installation not included), at Radio Shack Computer

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Centers. Software required to run an application processor is included in the card package. The file processor software package (26-6502), available for \$499.00 is a one-time purchase requirement.

Coaxial cable, required to interconnect the computers, is available in the following lengths: 20-foot cable (26-6510) for \$15.95; 50-foot cable (26-6511) for \$24.95; 100-foot cable (26-6512) for \$39.95; or by the foot (26-6513) for \$.21 per foot.

The last required component, the junction hub is available in two formats: (26-6504) serves as a "passive hub" for up to four processors and is available for \$79.00. For larger systems and longer distances, an active junction hub (26-6508) is available for \$995.00 and supports up to eight processors. Active hubs can then interconnect to each other for still larger systems.

ARCNET transfers programs and data at 2.5 million data bits per second and maintains user transparency allowing the user virtually independent operation. Additionally, the system provides system redundancy so that the failure of any one unit will not halt operations.

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